Lightner Double

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A Lightner double is a lead-directing double of an enemy slam contract. It frequently implies a void, and asks partner for a ruff. Generally speaking, partner is asked to:

1. Lead dummy's side suit, if one has been bid
2. Lead declarer's side suit, if one has been bid
3. Make any other unusual lead - usually partner's longest suit to get a ruff

Additionally, the double asks partner to NOT lead any suit that your side has bid.

Examples

♠5432
♥653
♦AT9876
♣void

LHO	Partner	RHO	You
1♥	Pass	2♣	Pass
3♥	Pass	6♥	Dbl[1]

[1] A Lightner double. This requests a club lead because your right-hand opponent bid clubs.

♠762
♥void
♦AT987
♣K9842

LHO	Partner	RHO	You
1♠	3♣	3♠	5♣
6♠	Pass	Pass	Dbl[1]

[1] A Lightner double. This asks your partner to NOT lead a club (your side's suit) and to find an unusual lead (in this case, a heart).

♠A762 ♥void ♦76 ♣T876532	LHO 1♦ 4NT 6♦	Partner Pass Pass Pass	RHO 3♦ 5♦ Pass	You Pass Pass Dbl[1]

[1] A Lightner double. Hopefully partner can find a heart lead.

Other Considerations

- The Lightner double is not in effect if the opponents are sacrificing at the 6- or 7-level. In those situations, it's more practical to use regular penalty doubles.
- Playing Lightner doubles, the opening leader can also infer what to lead if his partner did NOT double. For example, if the opponents bid a side suit en route to a slam contract and partner does not double, the inference is that partner does NOT want a lead of the enemy side suit.

Origins

The Lightner double is named for its creator, American player Theodore Lightner.

See also

- Lead-Directing Double

A conventional double that typically asks partner to lead a side suit that the opponents have bid.